

Alexandra (Alex) Ballyk

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Research Interests: Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Associate, Center for Experimental Social Science, New York University 2025 - present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Toronto 2025

Committee: Yoram Halevy (supervisor), Tanjim Hossain, Anne-Katrin Roesler

M.A in Economics, University of Toronto 2019

B.A.&Sc. in Economics and Chemistry (Dean's Honor List), McGill University 2018

RESEARCH

Working Papers

Strategic Communication Under Perceived Misalignment of Interests

Winner of the Robert Sugden Best Paper Award (2026)

Gender Differences in Job Application Strategies: An Experimental Investigation (with Annabel Thornton)

Preference Aggregation in Social Choice Under Risk

Work In Progress

Attribution Errors: Context-Dependence and Choice Distortions (with Ruchi Avtar)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Grants

UofT Economics Ph.D. Student Grant (CAD \$7,139.50) 2024

Institute for Gender and the Economy Grant (CAD \$5,000.00; with Annabel Thornton) 2023

UofT Economics Ph.D. Student Grant (CAD \$2,800.00) 2021

Awards

Robert Sugden Best Paper Award (£200.00) 2026

Ontario Graduate Scholarship (CAD \$15,000.00) 2024

Ontario Graduate Scholarship (CAD \$10,000.00 × 2) 2023, 2019

Canada Graduate Scholarship - Master's (CAD \$17,500.00) 2018

Faculty of Arts and Sciences Graduate Admission Award (CAD \$6,333.00) 2018

Arts Research Internship Award (CAD \$4,000.00) 2017

Tomlinson Engagement Award for Mentoring (CAD \$300.00 × 2) 2017, 2016

J.W. McConnell Scholarship (CAD \$3,000.00) 2014

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Course Instructorships 2022

Applied Game Theory (ECO316)

Teaching Assistantships 2018 - 2025

Behavioral and Experimental Economics (ECO438/1250, ECO421, ECO331)

Game Theory (ECO326, ECO316)
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (ECO206, ECO204, ECO200)
Principles of Microeconomics (ECO101)

Research Assistantships

2017 - 2024

Tanjim Hossain (University of Toronto)
Shari Eli, Marlène Koffi and Aloysius Siow (University of Toronto)
Yoram Halevy (University of Toronto)
Chris Barrington-Leigh (McGill University)

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS (* = scheduled)

2026: SWEET, FUR, UEA Behavioural Game Theory Workshop, ESA World*, BEEMA*
2025: Université Laval, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Florida State University, University of Arkansas, McMaster University, SITE Experimental Economics, ESA North America, VIEE
2024: GATE Research Roundtable, CIREQ Ph.D. Students' Conference, CEA, ESA World (accepted), ESA North America
2023: CIREQ Ph.D. Students' Conference, CEA
2022: Spring School in Behavioral Economics (poster)

OTHER ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Refereeing: Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

Programming Languages and Software: Python, MATLAB, oTree, Stata
Web Development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript

CITIZENSHIP AND LANGUAGES

Citizenship: Canadian
Languages: English (native), French (fluent), Spanish (proficient), German (basic)